

Big Energy. Better Research. Stop Hunting Excuses.

Visual reference cards from the Friday 8 May session led by director Corie Dawson. Use alongside the Session 1 toolkit. Print, pin to your wall, or keep on your desk.

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Keep on your desk. Read every morning.

Solutions vs excuses

Your brain is wired to find reasons you lost — to protect your ego. After every lost deal, override it. The only allowed next thought is: what is the solution next time?

LOSER MODE

Hunting for excuses

- “It’s the market.”
- “They didn’t have the budget.”
- “They’re tied to a coach.”
- “Bad time of year.”
- “They wanted to think about it.”
- “It’s not me — it’s them.”

WHAT IT DOES TO YOU

- Drains your energy. Reasoning is exhausting.
- Keeps your paycheck exactly where it is.
- Makes you predictable to your competitors.
- Feels comforting short-term — that’s the trap.

WINNER MODE

Hunting for solutions

- “Next time I’ll know their turnover.”
- “Next time I’ll lead with case studies.”
- “Next time I’ll plant the seed earlier.”
- “Next time I’ll pre-call with three questions.”
- “Next time I’ll use power words in the open.”
- “Next time I’ll pitch the top of the range.”

WHAT IT DOES TO YOU

- Generates energy. Solving is creative work.
- Compounds — every deal teaches the next.
- Builds a playbook competitors can’t copy.
- Feels uncomfortable. Pushes you forward.

THE RULE

After every lost deal, write one sentence — what specifically you will do differently. No analysis of the prospect. No analysis of the market. Just your behaviour.

The energy magnet

Two magnets, always running. One pulls success in. One pushes failure away. Your only daily job is to keep both active.



PULL TOWARDS YOU

PEOPLE

Colleagues and friends who want you to win.

INFORMATION

Research, case studies, real product knowledge.

ENERGY

High-pace habits — early starts, exercise, focus.

BELIEF

Real conviction in the product (not performed).

SOLUTIONS

After every lost deal — what to try next.

PUSH AWAY FROM YOU

PEOPLE

Anyone quietly pleased when you struggle.

STORIES

Reasons, market noise, complaints, blame.

PACE

Lingering on calls. Slow follow-ups. 'I'll get to it.'

DOUBT

Hidden uncertainty about our product or process.

EXCUSES

Anything that sounds like 'it wasn't my fault.'

REMEMBER

If you don't curate this every day, you end up with a mixture of everything and anything — which is exhausting, and it shows up in your close rate.

The 5 P's research checklist

Prior Preparation Prevents Poor Performance. If you can't recite these from memory, postpone the meeting.

BEFORE YOU WALK INTO THE ROOM

you must be able to answer all of the below from memory

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Number of staff
Total headcount + key roles (drivers, ops, sales, admin). | EXAMPLE
e.g. "8 drivers, 1 office manager, 1 director." |
| ☐ Operating units
Trucks, vehicles, sites, locations — anything that scales their capacity. | EXAMPLE
e.g. "10 trucks, 60+ skip bins." |
| ☐ Average job value
What does one transaction look like? Range, then mid-point. | EXAMPLE
e.g. "\$300 small skip, \$2,000 commercial — mid ~\$1,000." |
| ☐ Monthly turnover (top of range)
Default to the highest plausible number. Don't under-state. | EXAMPLE
e.g. "\$200k–\$250k/month." Multiply self-reported by 2x. |
| ☐ Annual turnover & profit
Build a confident estimate. Pitch the top of the range. | EXAMPLE
e.g. "\$2.5M turnover, ~30% margin = \$750k profit." |
| ☐ Frequency / busy-ness
How often are jobs happening? Is there seasonality? | EXAMPLE
e.g. "Busy through summer, 80–100 jobs/month average." |
| ☐ Main competitors
Who are they up against? What do those competitors charge? | EXAMPLE
e.g. "2 local skip operators, both undercutting on price." |
| ☐ Existing digital footprint
Branded vs non-branded traffic, backlinks, current rankings. | EXAMPLE
e.g. "Mostly branded traffic, no backlinks, ranking page 4 for non-brand." |

DEFAULT RULE

When in doubt on any number — pitch the TOP of the plausible range. There is no upside to going in low. If they self-report, multiply by 2x as a baseline rule of thumb.

The pre-meeting confirmation call

60 seconds. High energy. Three questions. You hang up first. The pitch is half-won by the time you walk in the room on Friday.

THE SCRIPT *(adapt to your prospect — keep the rhythm)*

OPEN

“Hey [first name], Lucas here.”

FRAME THE URGENCY

“I’m busy, I know you’re busy.”

SHOW THE WORK

“I’m prepping for Friday — running keyword research and AdWords-vs-SEO projections.”

THE THREE Qs

“Three quick questions while I’m doing the calculations:

- 1. Roughly how many jobs per day right now?**
- 2. What’s your average job value?**
- 3. Who are the main competitors locally?”**

POWER-WORD CLOSE

“Perfect. Speak Friday.” [hang up]

FIVE RULES

- 1 HIGH ENERGY FROM SECOND ONE**
You're setting the tone for Friday's meeting. Snail pace here = snail pace there.
- 2 MAX THREE QUESTIONS**
Get in. Get out. The call is 60 seconds, not five minutes.
- 3 YOU HANG UP FIRST**
If they say 'I've got to go' before you wrap, you've overstayed. Beat them to it.
- 4 REFERENCE REAL WORK**
'Doing keyword research,' 'running projections.' Signals competence and effort.
- 5 CLOSE WITH A POWER WORD**
'Perfect.' 'Fantastic.' 'Superb.' Never 'ok' or 'no worries.'

Power words — the language of high energy

Words have weight. The team's default vocabulary is too soft. Make these swaps in every conversation.

STOP SAYING

"Excellent."

START SAYING

"Perfect." / "Amazing." / "Incredible."

WHY: 'Excellent' is a 7/10 word — polite but no force. Power words land.

STOP SAYING

"That sounds good."

START SAYING

"That's a superb opportunity."

WHY: Adds weight to ordinary moments. Two words: superb opportunity.

STOP SAYING

"It's \$1,500."

START SAYING

"It's only \$1,500."

WHY: The word 'only' makes the number feel small without changing it. Use it on every quote.

STOP SAYING

"Yeah, ok." / "No worries."

START SAYING

"Perfect — let's go."

WHY: Replace passive acknowledgement with forward motion.

STOP SAYING

"Have a think about it."

START SAYING

"On a 10, where are you sitting?"

WHY: Stops them from disappearing into a vague 'think.' Forces a real answer.

STOP SAYING

"I'll send through some info."

START SAYING

"I've got some great ideas — let me run you through them Friday."

WHY: Pre-loads the meeting with anticipation. They look forward to it.

The 'silly me' recovery

Pitch high. If they choke on the price, do not panic-drop. Frame the lower number as YOUR clever idea — not a concession.

THE WRONG WAY

Panic-drop the price

PROSPECT

"That's a lot more than I expected."

YOU

"Oh — well, I could probably do \$900..."

WHAT THEY HEAR

"The price wasn't real. They had room. What else are they hiding?"

WHAT THEY FEEL

Suspicion. Distrust. Rapid loss of authority.

RESULT

Lower price + lower trust + you've trained them to push every time.

THE RIGHT WAY

The 'silly me' reframe

PROSPECT

"That's a lot more than I expected."

YOU

"Hold that thought — let me run you through everything first." (Hold the price.)

LATER IN PITCH

"Silly me — I've actually got a great idea. We can do this and this, drop that. Gets you under \$900. How's that sound?"

WHAT THEY HEAR

"This person is solving my problem cleverly. They're looking out for me."

RESULT

Lower price + HIGHER trust + you stay the expert. The deal closes.

THE PRINCIPLE

When you drop the price unilaterally, you confirm the original number was inflated. When you re-engineer the package and arrive at a lower number, you confirm the original number was real — and you've done them a favour. Same final price. Completely different relationship.

The strategic plant

When you can't close today — because of a coach, a 'guy they know,' or a current vendor — don't fight. Plant a seed. Win the war in 6 months.

THE SCENARIO

The prospect tells you they need to run it past their business coach / their mate who does cheap websites / their existing vendor. You can feel the deal slipping. Direct argument will lose them now AND in the future.

1

PLANT THE SEED

"Totally fair — chat with them. To be honest, business coaches don't usually love this kind of thing. They're focused on getting fees out of you. So I'm guessing this conversation today probably doesn't go much further. That's usually how this plays out."

WHY: You're not arguing. You're calmly predicting the future. The seed sits in their head every time the coach disappoints them.

2

PREDICT THE TIMELINE

"From what I've seen with previous clients, three to six months in you'll be frustrated and you'll come back to us. That's usually when this works out properly."

WHY: Specific timeframes are sticky. They'll remember six months from now. Vague 'eventually' doesn't.

3

CONCEDE GRACEFULLY

"No stress. Have the chat. We'll catch up when the timing's right. You've got my number." [Hang up.]

WHY: No pursuit. No begging. They register that you're busy, you're calm, and you don't need them. That makes the seed more powerful.

THE LOGIC

If you're wrong, you don't get the deal — same outcome as today. If you're right, you get the deal in 6 months. Either way, you've lost nothing and possibly won everything.

Daily mindset card

Read every morning before your first call. Print this page. Pin it to your monitor.

TODAY'S MANTRA

It ain't over till I win.

ENERGY

Walk in fast. Speak clearly. Treat every meeting like the most important one of the day. Snail pace gets snail results.

RESEARCH

Know more about their business than they do. If you can't recite turnover, staff count, and main competitor — postpone the meeting.

BELIEF

If you doubt the product, the customer will too. Sales is energy transfer. You can't transfer belief you don't have.

SOLUTIONS

After every lost deal: ONE sentence. What will you do differently? No analysis of the prospect. No analysis of the market. Just your behaviour.

EFFORT

Effort beats show every time. The customer can smell a performance. Real preparation is the only thing that actually closes.

Change your energy. Change your paycheque.

— Corie Dawson